永不沉没的神话

The Myth of the Unsinkable



守法的泰坦尼克号，为何仍救不了所有人？

READ 纯净阅读

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RECALL 回想巩固

英文原文

On 10 April 1912 the opulent liner Titanic left Southampton on her maiden voyage. A 1911 trade journal had dubbed her and her sister ship "practically unsinkable". At about 11.40pm on 14 April she collided with an iceberg; by 2.20am she had vanished beneath the waves, and the death toll would surpass 1,500.

Folklore blames arrogance. Yet the Titanic was compliant with the law. Under 1894 rules, Britain's maritime regulator pegged lifeboat numbers to gross tonnage (volume, not weight) on a scale that topped out at 16 boats for 10,000 tons or more. At about 46,000 tons she carried 20, exceeding the requirement. Their capacity was 1,178, roughly half the 2,200 aboard: sufficient in law, inadequate at sea.

Within radio range, the steamer Californian kept an equally lawful routine. Her sole wireless operator, Cyril Evans, was on the payroll of the Marconi company; when he slept, so did the radio. Around 11.30pm he switched off his set. Hindsight may call that negligence, yet no rule obliged him to stay vigilant, so the Titanic's frantic distress calls went unheard there.

Between April and July 1912, inquiries in Washington and London heard testimony from survivors and the Californian's crew. That July, American legislation made round-the-clock radio watch compulsory. In January 1914 delegates of 13 nations signed the first Safety of Life at Sea convention, stipulating lifeboat seats for all, continuous radio watch, and an ice patrol. The First World War stalled the treaty; the patrol went ahead regardless.

The doomed liner sank within three hours. The outdated rules she sailed under had stayed afloat since 1894; it took her dead to discredit them.

中文译文

1912年4月10日，豪华邮轮泰坦尼克号驶离南安普敦，开始首航。1911年，一本行业期刊曾将它和姊妹船称为“几乎不会沉没的船”。4月14日晚约11时40分，它撞上一座冰山；到次日凌晨2时20分，船已沉入海中，最终遇难人数超过1500。

坊间说法将灾难归咎于傲慢。然而，泰坦尼克号符合当时的法律。根据1894年的规定，英国海事监管机构按总吨位确定救生艇数量；总吨位衡量的是容积，并非重量。这套分级标准的上限，是对1万总吨及以上的船只要求配备16艘救生艇。泰坦尼克号约4.6万总吨，带了20艘，超过法定要求。但这些艇只能容纳1178人，约为船上2200人的一半：法律上足够，海上救生却不足。

在无线电通信范围内，加州人号轮船的值班惯例同样没有违规。船上唯一的报务员西里尔·埃文斯受雇于马可尼公司；他一休息，电台也随之无人值守。晚上约11时30分，他关掉了设备。事后看来，这或许可称为疏忽，但当时没有规定要求他保持值守，因此泰坦尼克号急切的求救信号在加州人号上无人听到。

1912年4月至7月，华盛顿和伦敦的调查听取了幸存者和加州人号船员的证词。同年7月，美国立法强制要求全天候无线电值守。1914年1月，13个国家的代表签署首部《海上人命安全公约》，规定救生艇座位必须足够全员使用、电台连续值守，并开展冰情巡逻。第一次世界大战使公约搁置，冰情巡逻却仍然开展起来。

这艘在劫难逃的邮轮不到三小时就沉没了。它所遵循的过时规定，却自1894年起一直照常施行；直到船上众多生命逝去，这些规定才失去了公信力。

总吨位衡量容积；“没有违规”并不表示法律要求报务员关机。

核心词汇

先记这22项。连着下方的原文短语一起回想。

opulent adj.
豪华的；奢华的
the opulent liner Titanic

maiden voyage 名词短语
首航
on her maiden voyage

dub v.
把……称为
had dubbed her and her sister ship

collide with 动词短语
与……相撞
she collided with an iceberg

death toll 名词短语
遇难人数
the death toll would surpass 1,500

arrogance n.
傲慢；自大
Folklore blames arrogance

compliant with 形容词短语
符合；遵守
was compliant with the law

regulator n.
监管机构
Britain's maritime regulator

gross tonnage 名词短语
总吨位（衡量船内容积）
gross tonnage (volume, not weight)

capacity n.
容纳人数；容量
Their capacity was 1,178

sufficient adj.
足够的
sufficient in law

inadequate adj.
不足的；不够的
inadequate at sea

hindsight n.
事后认识；后见之明
Hindsight may call that negligence

negligence n.
疏忽；失职
Hindsight may call that negligence

oblige v.
强制；要求
no rule obliged him to stay vigilant

vigilant adj.
警觉的；保持值守的
no rule obliged him to stay vigilant

testimony n.
证词；证言
heard testimony from survivors

legislation n.
立法；法律
American legislation

compulsory adj.
强制的；必须履行的
radio watch compulsory

convention n.
国际公约
Safety of Life at Sea convention

stipulate v.
规定；明确要求
stipulating lifeboat seats for all

discredit v.
使失去信誉；证明不可靠
to discredit them

文中词汇与搭配

补充词汇共37项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

liner n.
大型客轮；邮轮

trade journal 名词短语
行业期刊

practically adv.
几乎；实际上

unsinkable adj.
不会沉没的

iceberg n.
冰山

vanish v.
消失

surpass v.
超过

folklore n.
坊间流传的说法

maritime adj.
海事的；海上的

peg v.
使挂钩；按某标准确定

to prep.
与……（peg…to搭配）

scale n.
分级标准；等级表

top out at 动词短语
最高达到；上限为

exceed v.
超过

requirement n.
规定的要求

roughly adv.
大约；大致

equally adv.
同样地

lawful adj.
合法的；未违规的

文中词汇与搭配 续

补充词汇共37项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

sole adj.
唯一的

wireless adj.
无线电的

operator n.
操作员；报务员

on the payroll of 介词短语
受雇于；领取……的薪酬

switch off 动词短语
关掉（设备）

frantic adj.
慌乱而急切的

distress call 名词短语
求救呼叫；求救信号

unheard adj.
未被听见的

survivor n.
幸存者

round-the-clock adj.
全天候的；不间断的

delegate n.
代表

continuous adj.
连续的；不间断的

patrol n.
巡逻

stall v.
使暂缓；使停滞

treaty n.
条约

regardless adv.
尽管如此；仍然

doomed adj.
在劫难逃的

outdated adj.
过时的

stay afloat 动词短语
维持有效；继续存在（比喻）

回想与回顾

先遮住下方答案，再把四个词放回原文。

01 Yet the Titanic was _____ the law.

02 Their capacity was 1,178, roughly half the 2,200 aboard: sufficient in law, _____ at sea.

03 Hindsight may call that _____, yet no rule obliged him to stay vigilant, so the Titanic's frantic distress calls went unheard there.

04 That July, American legislation made round-the-clock radio watch _____.

文章主线

- 沉船 1912年，号称几乎不沉的泰坦尼克号首航撞冰山，不足三小时沉没，逾1500人遇难。
- 救生 旧规按总吨位（容积）定艇数，万吨以上只需16艇；它有20艇、1178座，仅够船上2200人约一半。
- 守听 附近加州人号的唯一报务员关机休息并未违规，电台没听到求救；当时没有全天值守的强制规定。
- 改革 1912年美国强制全天守听；1914年13国签约，要求全员救生艇座位、连续守听和冰情巡逻。
- 教训 一战使公约搁置，冰情巡逻仍启动；沿用自1894年的旧规暴露出：合法配置，并不等于安全足够。

参考答案　1 compliant with 2 inadequate 3 negligence 4 compulsory